

CMS Targeted Probe & Educate (TPE)

Surviving Round 1, 2, and 3 Medicare audits.

What TPE Is: MACs audit 20–40 claims per round. If your error rate exceeds 15%, you advance to Round 2 and face 100% pre-payment review.

Top 3 CPT Codes Triggering TPE

Where MAC algorithms focus their initial probes.

- **High-Level E/M (99215):** Audited for medical decision-making complexity vs time.
- **Critical Care (99291):** Scrutinized for continuous direct physician time documentation.
- **Skin Substitutes (Q4100s):** Aggressively audited for precise wound sizing and wastage records.

The 30–Day ADR Response Sprint

How to compile an impenetrable Additional Documentation packet.

- **Immediate Flagging:** Log ADR letters on day one. Clock starts immediately.
- **Certified Coder Audit:** Independent review of chart notes against MAC local coverage article.
- **Pagination & Indexing:** Include a cover index highlighting exact pages meeting LCD criteria.

Deterministic Pre-Bill Safeguards

Preventing TPE selection before claims are billed.

- **E/M Bell Curve Benchmarking:** Monitor practice coding distribution against regional specialty norms.
- **Tamper-Evident Logs:** Maintain unalterable audit trails of every clinical decision.
- **Continuous Education:** Feedback loops between coding audits and provider charting.

Is Your Practice TPE–Ready?

Benchmark your coding documentation before Medicare sends a probe letter.

Compliance Audit: Request a complimentary 50–claim review at aetherahealthcare.com/compliance